

Figure 1: New archival options

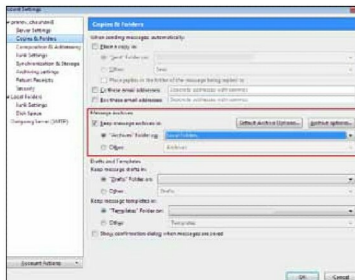


Figure 2: Enable archival

2. AutoArchive

By default, Thunderbird allows archival settings, but not automatically. For example, if you want to specify that emails older than 30 days should be moved to local folders, this add-on is for you. Once installed, the options highlighted in Figure 1 will become available. Also note that you need to set up archival as per your needs—specify local folders to save your emails, as shown in Figure 2. This add-on can be downloaded from <http://bit.ly/ZDAoJs>.

3. Message Archive Options

This add-on helps add more archiving options, like adding the granularity of the folders to either a single folder, an archive folder and a year sub-folder or a month, or a date or so on. Get it at <http://bit.ly/10GmE3b>. This adds, into archival settings, as shown in Figure 2, the *Default Archive Options* button, which opens the dialog seen in Figure 3—the options provided by this add-on.

4. Thunderbird Conversations

This add-on provides a conversation view for Thunderbird, including contacts tool-tips, attachment thumbnails, quick (inline) replies, integration with other add-ons, and much

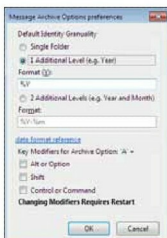


Figure 3: MAO options

more. Frankly speaking, if you are a fan of the Gmail conversation style, then this add-on is for you, so enjoy it. If not to your taste, skip this. You can get it at <http://bit.ly/hDE3tB>.

5. Forward as attachment

This is one of the features normally used in office. By default, Thunderbird only

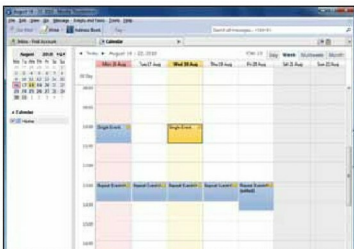


Figure 4: Calendar tweaked

provides inline attachments in forwards. This add-on provides the option to forward your email as inline or an attachment. Get it at <http://bit.ly/qnNUMX/>.

6. Highlighter

This add-on helps you quickly highlight some text in Thunderbird message-composing windows—I personally like this, as it really helps in day-to-day usage. Get it at <http://bit.ly/13QzNY2>.

7. Calendar Tweaks

This allows several tweaks to the Thunderbird/Lightning calendar user interface, including new selection styles and repeating event icons. It mimics the colours and styles found in MS Outlook. Figure 4 shows the look and feel after using this add-on. Get it at <http://bit.ly/WAFdrh>.

I personally use these add-ons for my customer conversations. I hope you find them useful. 

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The author works as an IT analyst at a well-known Indian software export company. He is interested in exploring open source software to spread awareness about using these in day-to-day life. The author can be reached at ce_pranav@yahoo.co.in.